

Tobias Treppmann

Product and design leader — AI shipped into production, in products where mistakes cost people money

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organisations.

PROFILE

I've designed software for fifteen years and led design teams for more than a decade of that, and I spent the last year building AI that ships rather than demos. At Bibel TV that's a support copilot in production and a fundraising system I built end to end. Before that, design leadership at Ninox and ChurchDesk, and five years at Datameer serving banks and insurers.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, live in production — assistive drafting for viewer letters, emails and social messages, following the handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. Restricted topics are enforced in the output. The draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry, and every send decision stays human. Rolled out fully optional, on team-lead encouragement rather than mandate. Complex letters take minutes not hours, temp staff write in the company voice from day one, and sceptics converted after their hardest case.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end — analysis, prompt architecture, prototype, then a production Claude skill. It generates follow-up content across in-app, web and video.
- Agentic engineering as design practice — prototypes run on real APIs and engineering ships from that code. Around 70% of AI-generated code lands. Iteration went from days to hours.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens with multi-platform sync. One commit reaches every platform, so consistency is structural rather than coordinated.
- Research at Bibel TV — interviews recorded and transcribed in Teams, then analysed with Claude.
- App redesign — leading the iOS, Android and web redesign for engagement and retention, with engineering on the experimentation framework. Direction validated, moving into development.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Booking module, product and design both — inherited a €20k client-funded booking project scoped internally as a standalone add-on module and reframed it into a platform capability. 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance at the launch customer, where funerals had to be bookable across 20+ cemeteries. It then shipped to every customer as a general booking capability.
- The rest of the suite was designed and initiated, not shipped — shared inbox and case management were scoped and specified. Only booking went live before the M&A centralisation.
- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries.
- AI in the research loop — Claude to summarise customer feedback, and support tickets plus HubSpot mined for trends, sentiment, feature requests and pain points.
- 1 direct report (designer). Main customer-facing contact for the launch parish, with direct customer contact throughout.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, summer 2025) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview. Chat and direct manipulation coexist. It became the basis for the public AI beta.
- Research at a scale a team cannot read — Dovetail as the shared insight repository, and Claude to analyse thousands of forum posts for sentiment and the pain points and feature requests underneath. Above a few hundred data points that analysis happens or it does not happen at all; below it, I read the responses, because nuance is the first thing a summariser drops.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — established design as a function co-equal with product and engineering.
- Performance calls in both directions — hired two, let two go. Coached the design lead through a hard cross-functional relationship. Set up shared design-system governance across 4 designers and engineering.
- Redesigned how the team ran meetings — pre-meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking, decisions written down. An engineer who had been talked over became one of the strongest contributors, and the habits outlived the problem. Inclusion as a design problem, not a value statement.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productise the service organisation. Case-by-case support became a standard catalogue.
- Methodology transfer — ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams. Primary stakeholder contact for the programme.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me inside a four-person design org, reporting to the VP Design. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- Design system, co-built — UX defined component behaviour and specs. UI executed the visual system.
- Research inside regulated industries — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach personas working inside banks and insurers.
- Design as a business partner — secured executive support for research and measurably increased UX maturity. Time-boxed strategic initiatives kept strategy and delivery in balance.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany
UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA
User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA
Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany
E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

AI in Production

Customer-support copilot live in production · AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end · Prompt-to-database interaction patterns · Human-in-the-loop by design: escalation as a first-class output, the send decision stays human · AI under GDPR-plus data-protection law · Agentic engineering with Claude Code on real APIs

Design Leadership

Senior Leadership Team member · 5 direct reports including a design lead · Performance calls in both directions · Coaching design leads through stakeholder conflict · Shared design-system governance across designers and engineering · Design established as co-equal with product and engineering

Regulated and Consequential-Stakes Product

Top US / CA / UK banks and insurers · GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law across six countries · EU accessibility compliance shipped · Research methods that reach users inside regulated institutions

Design Systems and Cross-Platform

Design system as an API · DTCG tokens · Live sync to Android and Figma, iOS and web endpoints defined · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma Variables · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React

AI in the Research Process

Claude for customer-feedback summarisation and for mining support tickets and HubSpot · Dovetail as a shared insight repository · Teams transcription into Claude analysis for interviews · The rule: AI analysis above a few hundred data points, where the alternative is not doing the work; direct reading below that, for the nuance a summariser drops

Research, Experimentation and Multi-Market

Iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach personas · A/B testing and experimentation infrastructure · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · Cross-Atlantic delivery across a six-hour gap · German native, English C2